

SCOTT R. PRELEWICZ

Hands-On Engineering Leader | Startup Builder | Applied AI

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PROFILE

Hands-on engineering leader and startup builder whose career moved from building products at massive scale to helping early-stage companies create the foundations for growth. At Zynga, helped launch and scale games to millions of daily users, then led FrontierVille engineering during a year when the game generated roughly \$160 million in revenue. Applied that experience to MVP redesign, architecture, organizational design, hiring, delivery, acquisition, and lean-team execution at the startups that followed. At Healthie, grew engineering from 4 to 12 while remaining approximately 50% hands-on as the company became profitable. More recently conceived, coded, and led production AI systems using the OpenAI API, embeddings, semantic search, and vector databases.

EXPERIENCE

Tech Lead | **Impacked Packaging** | Sep 2022 - Dec 2025 | Remote

- Led technical delivery of a B2B packaging marketplace built with React, Next.js, Ruby on Rails, PostgreSQL, Redis, and Heroku.
- Conceived and fully coded an OpenAI-powered product-description system, taking it from a hackathon idea to a production workflow that generated and refreshed SEO content across tens of thousands of products.
- Built AI content generation into supplier onboarding and used sample-based human review before catalog-wide processing; the system remains in production.
- Led the production deployment of OpenAI- and Qdrant-powered semantic search across the full catalog, replacing filter-only discovery with natural-language search and business-aware ranking.
- Contributed code and owned accuracy, caching, performance, QA, code review, and production-readiness decisions; early results improved search and product-discovery metrics before priorities shifted.
- Built supplier-catalog ingestion workflows that scraped, normalized, enriched, and loaded large onboarding datasets into PostgreSQL and Qdrant.
- Took over technical leadership of a nine-person engineering organization and introduced a leaner operating model that enabled a three-person team to continue delivering major product initiatives.

Independent Software Developer | **Freelance** | Nov 2019 - Aug 2022 | Remote

- Completed selected web-development projects using Ruby on Rails, PHP, JavaScript, React, SQL, HTML, and CSS.

Software Engineer | **Acuity Scheduling / Squarespace** | Sep 2018 - Oct 2019 | Remote

Acuity was acquired by Squarespace in April 2019.

- Built product features using PHP, JavaScript, React, and CSS.
- Took ownership of a manual-QA initiative and introduced processes that reduced production defects as the product scaled.
- Worked across distributed engineering, product, and support teams through Acuity's acquisition by Squarespace.

Director of Engineering | **Healthie** | May 2016 - Aug 2018 | New York, NY / Remote

- Joined shortly after the initial MVP launched and helped turn it into a product and engineering organization capable of supporting continued growth.
- Introduced the company's first structured development, release, and deployment process and made the case for a major product redesign.
- Helped the founders add dedicated design, product, and project-management leadership for the company's next stage.
- Helped establish the product and engineering foundation for Healthie's next stage: grew engineering from 4 to 12 while remaining approximately 50% hands-on in Ruby on Rails; the company became profitable in 2018 and later scaled to support more than 25,000 clinicians and 10 million patients.

Director of Engineering | GREE International | Dec 2013 - Apr 2015 | San Francisco, CA

- Led a 40-person engineering organization responsible for Modern War, Knights & Dragons, Crime City, and Kingdom Age, a portfolio that included multiple long-running top-50-grossing US mobile games.
- Introduced a consistent planning and delivery cadence where the organization previously lacked a dependable product roadmap.
- Reorganized the RPG studio around commercial performance and briefly served as acting co-GM while GREE recruited permanent leadership.
- Represented GREE as a speaker on an industry panel at GDC.

Senior Manager / Director, Engineering | Zynga | Jan 2010 - Jul 2013 | Multiple US studios

- Joined FrontierVille shortly before its 2010 launch as a Senior Software Engineer, then moved into engineering management and led a product pod whose Cyber Monday features set a new single-day revenue record for the game.
- Promoted to lead FrontierVille's full engineering organization during its peak engagement and revenue period, at approximately 6 million DAU and as many as 36 million MAU.
- Led FrontierVille engineering during a period when it represented 15% of Zynga's 2011 online-game revenue - approximately \$160 million based on company-reported results.
- Worked on CastleVille before launch and later returned to lead engineering after launch; the game reached approximately 5 million DAU within six days and more than 30 million MAU in its first month.
- Served as a principal evaluator and decision-maker for acquisitions, including traveling onsite to assess Buzz Monkey's approximately 50-person studio, and helped integrate acquired teams after closing.
- Led distributed engineering organizations of up to 35 people across Baltimore, San Francisco, Dallas, and Eugene; teams achieved 100% of engineering OKRs with 0% voluntary attrition.
- Created a co-lead program that developed new engineering leaders and accelerated promotions; its success led to company-wide adoption.

EARLIER EXPERIENCE

Principal Software Engineer, COMAND Solutions (2008-2009) | Senior Software Engineer, HUBNET (2007-2008) | Senior Software Engineer, Noein Incorporated (2005-2007) | Freelance Software Developer, Independent (2000-2009) | Senior Software Engineer, HUBNET (1998-2001)

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Applied AI & ML Systems: OpenAI API, prompt engineering, structured output, embeddings, semantic and vector search, Qdrant, hybrid retrieval and filtering, human-in-the-loop validation

AI-Assisted Development: Claude Code, code generation, debugging, refactoring, test-driven validation, code review, controlled integration of AI-generated changes

Languages & Frameworks: Ruby on Rails, PHP, JavaScript, React, Next.js, Python, Perl, Java, SQL, HTML, CSS

Data & Platforms: PostgreSQL, MySQL, Redis, Memcached, Heroku, REST APIs, Linux/Unix

Engineering & Organizational Leadership: Architecture and technical strategy, startup scaling, organizational design, hiring, performance management, manager development, product-engineering alignment, acquisition evaluation and integration

EDUCATION

State University of New York at Buffalo | Computer Science / Media Studies | 1996-1999